

Start Here



KINGB
KITS

Rum & Tiki Night

Sip it slow, then build something fun with it

PRE-PARTY PLANNING

- **Two pours per guest per rum** - one neat, one built into a tiki drink. Three rums covers a full flight.
- Pick **one tier** from the Rumbase and stay in it - mixing a \$18 rum against a \$45 pot-still rum just makes the cheap one taste flat.
- Buying or BYO both work - three bottles covers the tasting; extras only matter for a bigger crowd.

SET A DATE AND SEND INVITES

- Say "tiki night," not "rum tasting." It sets the right expectation: playful, not a spirits seminar.
- Tell guests to eat first. Tiki drinks hide their proof behind citrus and syrup.

PARTY SETUP

- Crushed ice matters more here than any spirit in this line - see the Tiki Primer before you buy.
- Set out citrus, garnishes, and glassware for a second round.
- A tasting card and a small glass at every seat before anyone pours.

DURING THE PARTY

- Taste each rum **neat first**, then on the rocks, then in the tiki drink - the same rum reads differently each way.
- Rotate through the tier lightest to boldest, same rule as every kit in this line.
- Close with a vote on the night's best build, not just the best rum.

SNACK PAIRINGS

Grilled pineapple, coconut shrimp, spiced nuts, dark chocolate. Skip heavy cream sauces - they flatten the citrus in every drink that follows.

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Invitation

Editable Canva template

Set up your RSVP before you send the invite:

1. [Click to copy the RSVP form](#) - your own private copy, replies land in your account, not ours.
2. Click Send in your new form and copy the link, then open the Invitation above, click the QR code, hit Edit, paste your link, and click Update code.

Know Your Rum, Build Your Drink

Rum has no legal style rulebook - here's the one that actually matters at the bar.

Rum Styles

Unlike Scotch or tequila, "rum" has almost no enforced production rules - style is set by habit and geography, not law.

White / Silver

Light-bodied, often filtered after aging to strip color. Clean, faintly sweet - the Newbie-tier default and the tiki backbone for a Daiquiri.

Gold / Amber

Aged longer or colored for a mixing-friendly middle ground. More vanilla and caramel than white, still light enough to mix.

Dark / Navy Strength

Pot-still and pit-aged, often blended from multiple islands. Funky esters, char, dried fruit - what a proper Jungle Bird or Navy Grog is built on.

Agricole & Rhum

Distilled from fresh cane juice instead of molasses, mostly French Caribbean. Grassy, vegetal, almost tequila-adjacent - a different animal entirely.

The Tiki Formula

Every classic tiki drink is the same four-part structure, just with different rums and fruit in each slot.

Spirit

Usually two rums of different styles layered together - that's what "tiki" actually means more than any single ingredient.

Sour

Fresh lime almost always, sometimes with orange or passionfruit alongside it. Bottled juice is the single most common way to ruin a tiki drink.

Sweet

Orgeat (almond syrup), falernum, honey, or demerara syrup - picks the drink's whole personality more than the rum does.

Spice / Float

A dash of bitters, a float of overproof rum, or a spiced syrup on top - the finishing note, added last and never stirred in.

Cane to Cocktail

● Milling

Sugarcane is crushed for juice, or the juice is boiled down into molasses first - this single fork decides agricole vs everything else.

● Fermentation

Days for molasses-based rum, often under 48 hours for cane-juice agricole. Wild or added yeast, and it's a huge flavor lever either way.

● Distillation

Column stills give a lighter, cleaner spirit. Pot stills keep more congeners and funk - Jamaican pot-still rum is the extreme end of this.

● Aging

Tropical aging (Caribbean heat) matures rum roughly twice as fast as a cool warehouse - a 5-year tropical-aged rum can taste like a 10-year one elsewhere.

● Blending

Most rum on a shelf is a blend of multiple ages and sometimes multiple islands - single-barrel rum is the exception, not the rule.

Glassware & Garnish Checklist

- ☐ Tiki mugs or double rocks glasses - anything with some visual presence
- ☐ **Crushed ice**, not cubed - it dilutes faster and that's the point in a tiki drink
- ☐ Fresh limes, oranges - bottled juice will flatten every drink you make
- ☐ Mint sprigs, pineapple fronds, or a paper umbrella for the theater of it
- ☐ Orgeat or falernum if you're building real tiki drinks, not just pours

Pick a Tier, Buy Three Bottles

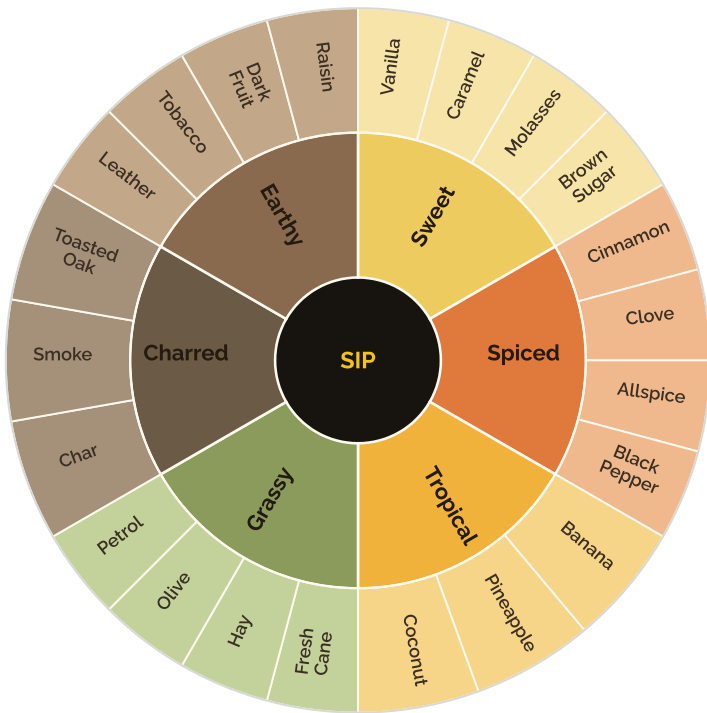
Each row pairs a rum tier with the tiki drink built to show it off.

TIER	 RUM PICKS	 BUILD	TASTING NOTES	PER BOTTLE
Newbie	Bacardi Superior Plantation 3 Stars Denizen White Don Q Cristal	Daiquiri	Clean, faint banana, light vanilla	\$16–22
Casual	Appleton Estate Signature Mount Gay Eclipse El Dorado 8 Year Plantation Original Dark	Mai Tai	Caramel, baking spice, dried fruit	\$22–32
Aficionado	Smith & Cross Navy Strength Hamilton 86 Demerara Rhum J.M Agricole Blanc Foursquare Exceptional Cask	Jungle Bird	Funky ester, grassy cane, char, overproof heat	\$30–55

Budgeting tip: a 750ml bottle pours 25–30 tastes at 0.75 oz - even 6 guests taking a neat pour, a rocks pour, and a tiki drink from each of three rums only uses about half of each bottle. One bottle per rum comfortably covers the whole group.

Speak the Language of a Build

One wheel for the rum itself, one for what you build around it.



Rum



Tiki Build

Using the wheels: taste the rum first and find its inner-ring category on the left wheel, then work out to the specific note. The right wheel works the same way for whatever you build around it - citrus, syrup, spice. Notice how many words show up on both: that overlap is what makes a build actually work.

Newbie

Light

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Tasting Card

WHITE RUM · BUILT INTO A DAIQUIRI



MY RUM

POURED (TIME)

Neat

room temp



Amount

On the Rocks

opens it up



Amount

In the Daiquiri

the real test



Built at

FAVORITE BUILD TONIGHT

BUY AGAIN?

- Light, forgiving, and the easiest rum to taste a real difference in when mixed vs neat.
- Fresh lime only - bottled juice will flatten this drink completely.

Casual

Medium

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Tasting Card

GOLD/AMBER RUM · BUILT INTO A MAI TAI



MY RUM

POURED (TIME)

Neat

room temp



Amount

On the Rocks

opens it up



Amount

In the Mai Tai

the real test



Built at

FAVORITE BUILD TONIGHT

BUY AGAIN?

- Caramel and baking spice should show up in all three checkpoints, just louder each time.
- Orgeat is doing more work than the rum here - taste it on its own once.

Aficionado

Bold



Tasting Card

NAVY-STRENGTH / AGRICOLE · BUILT INTO A JUNGLE BIRD



MY RUM

POURED (TIME)

Neat

room temp



Amount

On the Rocks

opens it up



Amount

In the Jungle Bird

the real test



Built at

FAVORITE BUILD TONIGHT

BUY AGAIN?

- Not a beginner's lineup - the funk and overproof heat can surprise people.
- Campari's bitterness in the Jungle Bird is what tames this rum's funk. Taste the bitterness on its own too.

Everything on the list, then close the night with a real ballot.

- ☐ **Rum** - one bottle per rum, your chosen tier (Rumbase, pg 3)
- ☐ Fresh limes and oranges - not bottled juice
- ☐ Orgeat or falernum, plus a demerara or simple syrup
- ☐ Crushed ice - buy a bag or crush cubes yourself, don't skip this
- ☐ Tiki mugs or double rocks glasses, one per guest
- ☐ Mint, pineapple, or an umbrella for garnish
- ☐ Angostura bitters
- ☐ Pen at every seat for the Tasting Cards

Right glass for the table. A tiki mug or double rocks glass works for the whole tasting portion - no need for anything fancier until you're building drinks for a crowd.

Pass around at the end of the night. Whichever build gets the most votes is next round's starting point.

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